

A flash introduction to Git

A SHORT GUIDE FOR RESEARCHERS

Qing-Long Liu

30.09.2026

Why version control?



A FAMILIAR FOLDER

```
thesis.tex  
thesis_final.tex  
thesis_final_v2.tex  
thesis_final_really.tex
```

Which version did I send to my supervisor?

What changed since then?

Version control keeps a history of recorded versions.

How Git helps

A **repository** is your project together with its Git history.

1 / EDIT

Your files

Save your changes in the editor.

2 / SELECT

Staging area

```
git add
```

Select current content for the next commit.

3 / RECORD

Commit

```
git commit
```

Record a snapshot with a message.

Saving a file does not create a commit.

Edit after `git add`? Add again to include the later edits.

Commits stay on your computer. An external backup is separate.

The first commit

Start in a new folder containing `manuscript.tex`.

```
git init
git status
git add manuscript.tex
git status
git commit -m "Record initial manuscript draft"
git status
git log
```

`status:` current state `log:` recorded history

More info: <https://scnlong.github.io/git-in-five-minutes/>

WATCH THE FILE

Untracked

Staged

Committed

Thank you!